

Realme 11 Pro

A substantial upgrade

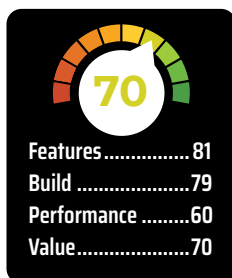
Realme's number series, Narzo series, and C series are ludicrously popular in our country given the features on offer at very competitive prices. Recently, Realme launched its latest number series phones in India – the Realme 11 Pro and Realme 11 Pro+. At my briefing meeting with the company, I was told that both the Realme 11 Pro and Pro+ improve upon last year's Realme 10 Pro+, so there are some massive upgrades on the vanilla 11 Pro version, and they're not wrong in claiming that. So, naturally, when the Realme 11 Pro showed up at the Digit Test Labs, I was cautiously excited to review it and experience the upgrades. Compared to its predecessor, the Realme 10 Pro, the Realme 11 Pro sports a lot of improvements on paper; but how does the Realme 11 Pro actually perform in real life and how much has it improved? Does it match up to the competition at ₹23,999? I answer these questions and more in my detailed review of the Realme 11 Pro.

BUILD AND DESIGN

When you set your eyes on the Realme 11 Pro, one of the more obvious improvements is the design. Gone is the cheap-looking plastic rear panel and now we've got a sophisticated vegan leather finish on the back of the Oasis Green and Sunrise Beige colour variants. We got the latter for review, and it exudes class that's quite rare to see at this price point. The look has been co-developed with ex-Gucci designer, Matteo Menotto. There's also an Astral Black variant that comes with a simple matte-textured back; but simply because of how classy the leather variants look, we'd suggest that you stray away from the black variant.

The phone also features an eye-catching circular camera module which houses the two camera lenses and a third pseudo-

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lens design – for symmetry reasons, I guess? There's also a flash on top and "100 MP OIS Camera" written on the bottom. A golden zip-like pattern cuts through this module. This design flair can be a bit polarising, but I personally loved it; I thought it gave the phone a certain

character. One thing missing is any kind of Ingress Protection – so the phone is neither dust nor water-resistant, which is disappointing but not a deal-breaker for most. The Realme 11 Pro has nice and rounded corners both on the front and the back which makes the phone ridiculously comfortable to hold, however, the curved display does register some mistaps. The phone is lightweight too, at just 189 g (leather variant). The frame of my Sunrise Beige variant is a striking gold colour, which once again, makes the phone look much more expensive than it is. All that being said, the Realme 11 Pro is possibly one of the most stylish phones ₹25K with oodles of character. A head-turner for sure!

DISPLAY

Now that you have a fair idea about the

looks of the display, let's get into the nitty-gritty. It packs a 6.7-inch AMOLED screen with up to 120 Hz refresh rate and 360 Hz touch sampling rate. Do note that the Realme 10 Pro only had an IPS LCD display, so it's a tangible improvement. The display is topped with AGC Drag-onTrail Star glass for protection. Realme also promises a 1,260 Hz Instantaneous touch sampling rate – and boy, did we feel it during gaming. Touches were registered almost instantaneously with little to no lag or delay, making it a smooth experience at under ₹25K. There's an optical in-display fingerprint sensor that worked a bit slower than ideal, during my testing.

The display has an FHD+ resolution which is plenty crisp for the price point. Colours look vibrant and there's unmistakable detail in every frame. The display also supports 1 billion+ colours which should help avoid colour banding and it is a definite improvement over the Realme 10 Pro. You've got evenly thin bezels all the way around the AMOLED panel as well. As for brightness, there's little to complain about. Realme promises 950 nits of peak brightness and in my testing, I got a reading of 916 nits under direct sunlight on Auto-Brightness Mode. Pretty sweet. The AMOLED display can also get pretty dim, so the screen won't bother you even when you're using it at night with the lights turned off.

Realme has added HDR10+ support, but Dolby Vision support is missing. While it is good to have HDR10+ support, streaming services such as Netflix still don't support HDR on the Realme 11 Pro. It could take a few updates to support to finally land, but this is something that should ideally be done pre-launch.

PERFORMANCE

At under ₹25,000, the Realme 11 Pro performs decently well; but this performance is colossally hindered by bloatware. I have never experienced these levels of hardcore bloatware pushing. OPPO and OnePlus devices have similar numbers of pre-installed apps, but it is not as intense.

Let me explain: not only does the phone come pre-installed with a bunch of third-party apps, but you also have about